

INDUSTRY NEWS

Electronics cluster worth ₹ 710 million gets Central nod

The Central government has granted an in-principle approval to Maharashtra Chamber of Commerce Industry and Agriculture (MCCIA) for setting up a brownfield electronics cluster. The cluster, conceived by MCCIA under the government's cluster development scheme for diverse industrial sectors, will improve the testing, designing and prototyping capacities of small and medium enterprises (SMEs), which lack the financial muscle to invest in high-priced electronics equipment required for these functions.

The project will be set up with an investment of ₹ 710 million, of which ₹ 500 million will come from the Centre as grant-in-aid, while the remaining will be contributed by the members of the chamber.

MAIT and CHIPS Signs MoU

Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology, MAIT, an apex body representing the ICT Industry in India, has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Chhattisgarh Infotech Promotion Society (CHIPS), the nodal agency for electronics, IT and ITes in Chhattisgarh.

Anwar Shirpurwala, executive director, MAIT, and Saurabh Kumar, CEO, CHIPS, signed the MoU under the aegis of Opportunity Chhattisgarh 2015. Shirpurwala, in his inaugural address, said that the MoU aims at contributing to the establishment of electronics system design and manufacturing (ESDM) and facilitate implementation of Digital India programme in Chhattisgarh.

The MoU is expected to give a major thrust to the nation and state's economy in propelling the growth of the IT and electronics industry in India.

In Focus

BEL announces two new GMs

Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) has appointed two new general managers, namely, B.S. Ravi, GM (military radar)/BEL, Bengaluru, and Shikha Gupta, GM (strategic planning)/BEL, corporate office.

Socomec appoints Sushil Virmani as MD for India operations

Socomec, a power solution specialist, has appointed Sushil Virmani as MD for India operations. In this role, he will head all four business applications on the company's strategic plan.

Anjan Lahiri named Birlasoft CEO

Former Sasken CEO and Mindtree co-founder Anjan Lahiri has been appointed CEO of Birlasoft, the information-technology arm of CK Birla Group, headquartered in Noida. He will be based in New Jersey, the USA, and will report directly to chairman Amita Birla.

Acer appoints Panigrahi as senior director

Computer maker Acer has appointed Chandrashekar Panigrahi as senior director for its consumer business group in India. The consumer business group includes consumer product-management teams, retail management teams, e-commerce, and modern trade and distribution teams.

Himanshu Chakrawarti leaves The MobileStore

Himanshu Chakrawarti has quit as CEO of The MobileStore. The chain, which is owned by Essar Group, currently operates 700 stores across India and recently strengthened its e-commerce presence.

Alok Gupta, president, sales and marketing, Essar Steel, will take interim charge of The MobileStore until a replacement is appointed.

New electronics policy to be launched in Maharashtra

Maharashtra government is rolling out a new state electronics policy, which is aimed at creating a favourable regulatory dispensation in Maharashtra to make it competitive with respect to other states like Karnataka and Punjab in terms of fiscal and non-fiscal incentives being offered.

Incentives like availability of reimbursement of VAT for goods produced and sold within the state, interest subsidy, reducing threshold of mega projects and lowest VAT rate to be levied on electronics products used for data communication by declaring such products as goods of special importance are expected to rejuvenate the efforts of the state administration.

PC manufacturing capacity worth US\$ 4 billion lying idle

While the Modi government offers special incentives to companies

for manufacturing smartphones and tablets in India, makers of personal computers (PCs) feel that the administration is making it tougher for them to do business in the country.

According to MAIT, an estimated US\$ 4 billion worth of PC manufacturing capacity is lying idle in the country. Large manufacturers such as Dell and Acer have said that the industry needs a long-term policy roadmap from the government for them to consider manufacturing in India.

According to the new rules set by the government, power adaptors and batteries also require BIS certification, which was previously required for a whole product, such as a PC or notebook. Component-level certifications have made it difficult for companies to sell products in India.

India may lose ₹ 240 billion LED orders to China

The government of India has launched a major green push to replace 750 million tungsten bulbs